

Tobias Treppmann

A design leader who still builds

CONTACT

LOCATION

Berlin, Germany

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LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching and product-strategy consulting for mission-driven organizations.

PROFILE

I lead design functions and I never stopped building. At Ninox I ran design and, for four months, product as well: nine people across design, UX writing, product and data science. The last year has been hands-on by choice. The quality bar lives in the build, not in the review.

32

off-system values the build caught in a library believed clean after two cleanup passes

Nine reports

across design, UX writing, product management and data science, on the SLT

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (broadcaster in linear-to-streaming transformation — iOS, Android, web and connected TV; engineering supplied by an external agency) · Hamburg + Berlin, Germany

- I prototype in code, not in specs — real code against real production APIs. Engineering ships from it.
- A quality bar the build enforces — six checks, identical on a laptop and in CI. They reject an unresolved token reference and a hardcoded color, which both render. 32 caught.
- UI quality across four surfaces — iOS, Android, web and connected TV, held by DTCG tokens in three tiers. One commit propagates everywhere.
- A color engine in OKLCH — k-means clustering rather than RGB, so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight. WCAG contrast validated inside the algorithm.
- Audit the products, then improve them against numbers — a full experience audit and the redesign from it, taken through to implementation. Conversion and usage metrics as standing practice.

Head of Product Design · Interim Head of Product

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (no-code business platform — DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Two functions at once, nine reports, four disciplines — Product Design and Product held together, July to October 2023. Senior Leadership Team throughout.
- Hired 2, promoted 2 — including the consultant who then took Head of Product. Coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship.
- Design made co-equal by agreement rather than assertion — a collaborative UX-maturity self-assessment with product and engineering, after which design held parity in planning.
- Prompt-to-database onboarding, with the CEO and technical co-founder — freelance, summer 2025. The AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview.

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk (vertical ERP — ~50 people, DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- The measured outcome I trust most — a booking capability that cut coordination time by 70%, at 90% acceptance with the launch customer, then shipped to every customer.
- Accessibility past our own front door — we audited our website and also the websites customers build with the platform, for EU Accessibility Act compliance.
- Product management and all of product design at once — across six countries I wrote the specs and ran the ticket board engineering worked from.

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (collaborative data analytics for top US / CA / UK banks and insurers) · Berlin, Germany · team across Germany and NYC

- Five years of data-dense interfaces — pivot tables, aggregated JSON views, result cards, filter logic. The hardest was the query-builder preview, where the result is a sample.
- Research as a habit, not an event — pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach analysts working inside regulated banks and insurers.

UX Strategy Lead

2014 – 2016

Spreadshirt (international e-commerce, hundreds of thousands of consumers — 200+ people) · Leipzig, Germany

- Research that changed a consumer product's direction — leadership wanted a 60-second automated journey. Shop owners valued the design step most. The strategy moved, and the mobile prototype went to production.

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

Senior Mentor · *CareerFoundry* · 2016 – 2026 · Remote · a decade reviewing and critiquing designers' work

Product & UX Strategist · *Hypoport hub SE* · 2021 – 2022 · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany

Mentor · *Interaction Design Foundation* · 2020 – 2022 · Remote

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

User Experience Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

SKILLS

Hands-On Craft

Prototypes in real code against real production APIs, web first and then Android, with engineering shipping from that code · engineering ships from that code · A color engine live in production, k-means clustering in OKLCH so artwork-driven themes carry even perceptual weight · Selah — Mindful Transitions, a macOS app designed, built and shipped solo on the Mac App Store

Visual, Interaction and Polish

UI quality owned across iOS, Android, web and connected TV · DTCG tokens in three tiers synced live to Figma and Android, so one commit propagates everywhere · Six checks in CI that refuse off-system work, which identified 32 off-system values in a library believed clean · WCAG contrast validated inside the color algorithm; custom motion easing curves carried by the design system

Leading and Coaching Designers

Product Design and Product held together at Ninox, nine reports across four disciplines, Senior Leadership Team · Hired two, promoted two; coached the design lead through a strained engineering relationship · Ten years as a senior mentor at CareerFoundry, two at the Interaction Design Foundation

Research, Analytics and Product Instinct

Conversion and usage metrics analyzed as standing practice; interviews recorded and analyzed with Claude · Competitive analysis against the global apps entering this market · Pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening at Datameer to reach analysts inside regulated banks · At Spreadshirt, interviews moved product strategy away from a 60-second automated journey · The measurable impact I trust most is ChurchDesk's 70% coordination-time reduction at 90% acceptance, and it is workflow efficiency

Working with Product, Engineering and Data Science

A data scientist among the nine reports at Ninox; interim Head of Product with three product managers · Design-system governance run as a cross-functional working group with an escalation path · At Bibel TV the handoff crosses a company boundary to an external engineering agency and holds anyway · Claude Code, Cursor and Zed as daily tools; Android/Kotlin, SwiftUI, React and web